

# How TESS Detects Threats

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TESS supports public awareness by combining official near-Earth object data, observatory readiness checks, and clear mission dashboards into one understandable workflow.

### The basic idea

TESS does not invent asteroid warnings. It organizes public data, local observatory readiness, and mission status into practical displays that help people understand what is happening.

### Evidence before alarm

A dashboard notice is not an impact prediction. Every public statement should trace back to authoritative sources and current observations.

### Practical workflow

- ? 1. **\*\*Use official feeds\*\*** - start with NASA/JPL, Minor Planet Center, IAWN, and other authoritative sources.
- ? 2. **\*\*Check freshness\*\*** - confirm that data timestamps and dashboard feeds are current before interpreting them.
- ? 3. **\*\*Compare context\*\*** - look at size estimates, miss distance, velocity, uncertainty, and time until close approach.
- ? 4. **\*\*Check readiness\*\*** - confirm whether observatory, AllSky, communication, and website systems are healthy.
- ? 5. **\*\*Explain plainly\*\*** - translate technical data into calm public language without exaggeration.
- ? 6. **\*\*Escalate carefully\*\*** - only elevate concern when evidence and official sources support it.

### What TESS can show

- ? Closest public close-approach summaries.
- ? Mission dashboard health and data freshness.
- ? Links back to NASA/JPL and other official sources.

### What TESS should avoid

- ? Claiming official warning authority.
- ? Presenting stale data as current.
- ? Turning routine close approaches into panic language.